

Account Deletion Procedure

Effective Date: July 28, 2025

Owner: Privacy Officer

Version: 1.0

Applies To: All TalentForge user accounts (job seekers and recruiters)

1. Purpose

This document outlines the step-by-step procedure for processing user account deletion requests in accordance with our Privacy & Cookies Policy, and applicable data protection laws like GDPR, PIPEDA, and CCPA.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to:

- All registered users of TalentForge (Job Seekers and Recruiter Company Profiles)
- User-initiated deletion via the TalentForge web application

3. Deletion Method

Users can delete their accounts at any time through their profile settings.

Steps for Users:

1. Log in to your TalentForge account.
2. Navigate to **Profile**.
3. Click on **“Delete My Account”**.
4. Confirm the deletion action when prompted.

4. Backend Process (Post-Deletion)

Upon confirmation from the user:

1. The user’s account and associated data are immediately deleted from the database.
2. This includes:
 - Personal information (name, email, profile details)
 - Uploaded resume or job listing details
 - Company/recruiter profile (if applicable)
3. Session tokens and cookies are invalidated.
4. A final confirmation email is sent to the user confirming account deletion.

5. Data Handling Notes

- **Deletion is permanent and irreversible.**
- **No data is retained**, unless required by law.
- Render.com (our hosting provider) may retain **server-level logs**, which are not tied to user profiles and are managed per Render’s own retention policy.

6. Logging (Internal)

- Account deletion is logged for audit purposes with:
 - Date and time of deletion
 - User ID or email
 - Method (UI-triggered)

No personally identifiable data is retained in the log beyond what's required for compliance tracking.

7. Exceptions

There are **no exceptions**, all users can delete their own accounts. No admin approval is needed. Once deleted, accounts cannot be restored.

8. Review Cycle

This procedure will be reviewed **annually** or whenever a major change is made to the account deletion functionality.

9. Parent Policy

- Privacy Policy